Full/Wing Backs

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Player counts

In this project, there are a total of 129 full/wing backs considered, with

- 14 full/wing backs in 12 teams in the English FA Women's Super League
- 17 full/wing backs in 12 teams in the German Frauen Bundesliga
- 29 full/wing backs in 16 teams in the Spanish Liga F
- 16 full/wing backs in 10 teams in the Italian Serie A Women

Results

Results for 2 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_2_cluster				
0	15	12	16	17
1	15	16	24	14

Eventually the split between two clusters seems pretty equal, though a bit more biased towards cluster 1 for Frauen Bundesliga and Liga F.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 players tend to receive and take defensive actions in higher areas, especially when it comes to defending where there are more variations on where those actions happened, while also counterpress more in opposition half . They progress more by carrying than passing, and attempt more crosses and passes into the opposition box.
- On the other hand, cluster 1 players tend to pass more forward and longer while receiving and defending from lower areas, especially when it comes to blocking inside own box.

Therefore, based on these results,

- Cluster 0 players can be seen as advanced carrying wingbacks
- Cluster 1 players can be seen as traditional while forward passing fullbacks

Results for 3 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
0	10	8	12	12
1	11	10	15	10

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
2	9	10	13	9

Comparing results for 2 clusters against 3 clusters

kmeans_3_cluster	0	1	2
kmeans_2_cluster			
0	41	0	19
1	1	46	22

It seems like k = 3 cluster 2 is a shared middle zone between the two k = 2 clusters.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 shows more positiveness towards backward and ground pass percentage, progressive carrying into the final third being the main method of progression, and average carrying speed. Progression is done more via carrying than passing. Defensive actions are also taken at higher positions with greater variance, even in opposing half as shown in counterpress actions.
- While for cluster 1, these players perform defensive actions at much lower positions with much less variations in the locations, especially in blocking inside their own box.
- Cluster 2, on the other hand, shows more positiveness towards forward progressive passing metrics, including crosses and passes into box while receiving and dribbling from wider zones, and also forward carrying. Unlnike cluster 0, progression is done more via passing than carrying.

Hence, the following conclusions can be made:

- Cluster 0 can be seen as advanced carrying wingbacks
- Cluster 1 can be seen as traditional defending fullbacks
- Cluster 2 can be seen as progressive passing and chance creating wingbacks

Breakdown of results by players

Findings and radar plots for each full/wing back are in their own files:

- Ona Batlle - Barcelona
- Eve Perisset - Chelsea
- Frederike Kempe - RB Leipzig
- Jayde Riviere - Manchester United
- Sofie Svava - Real Madrid
- Lucy Bronze - Barcelona
- Katie McCabe - Arsenal

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Appendix

Radar plots for 2 clusters full/wing backs' averages

All leagues

Passing

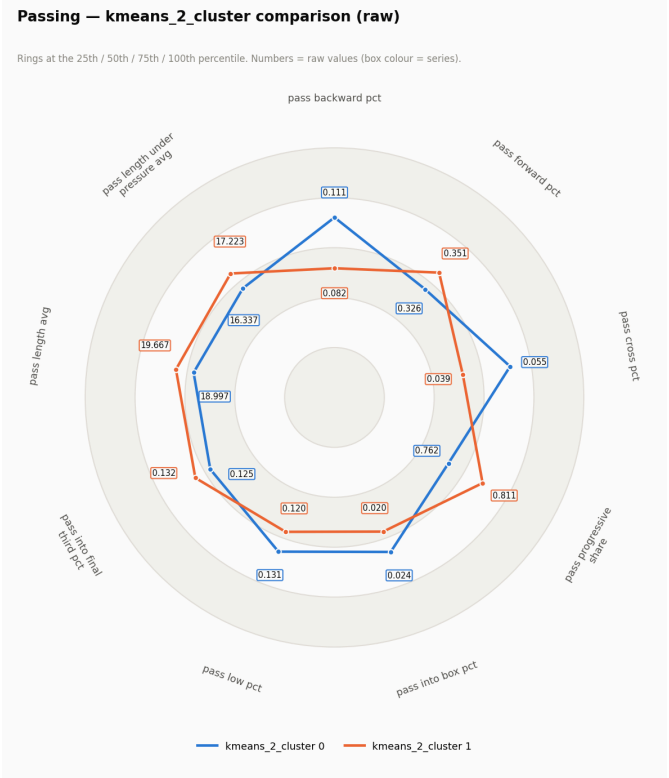


Figure 1: Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

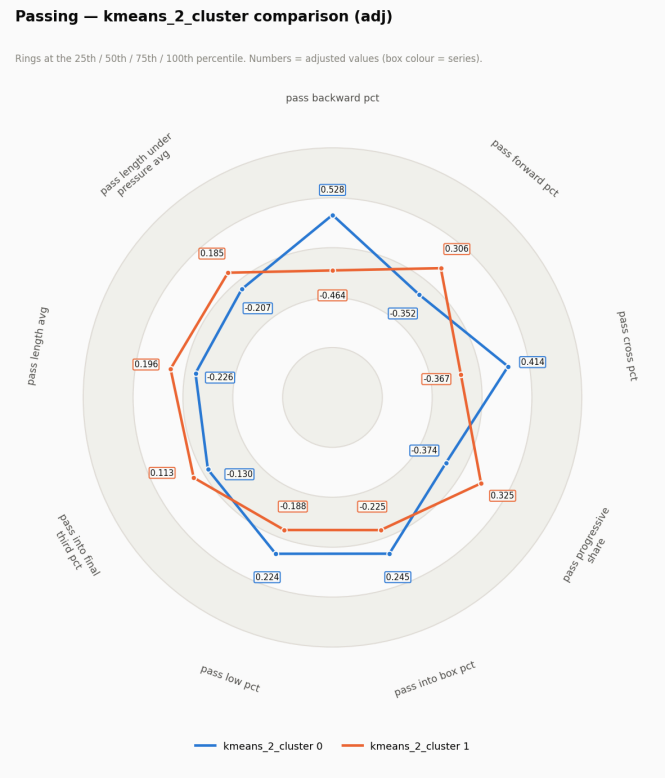


Figure 2: Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

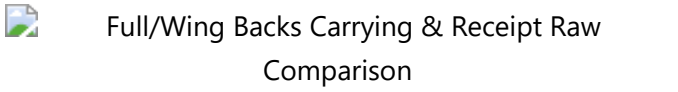


Figure 3: Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

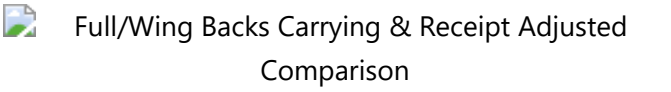


Figure 4: Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

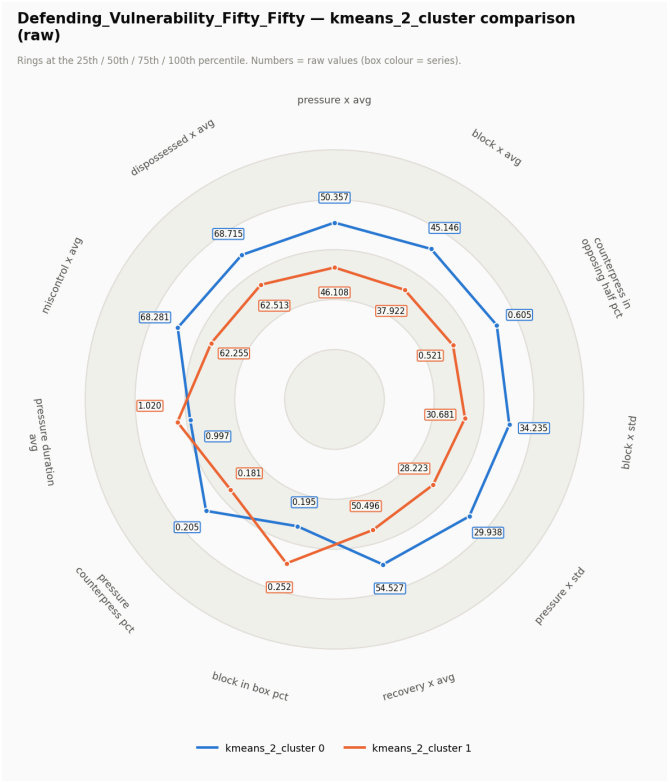


Figure 5: Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

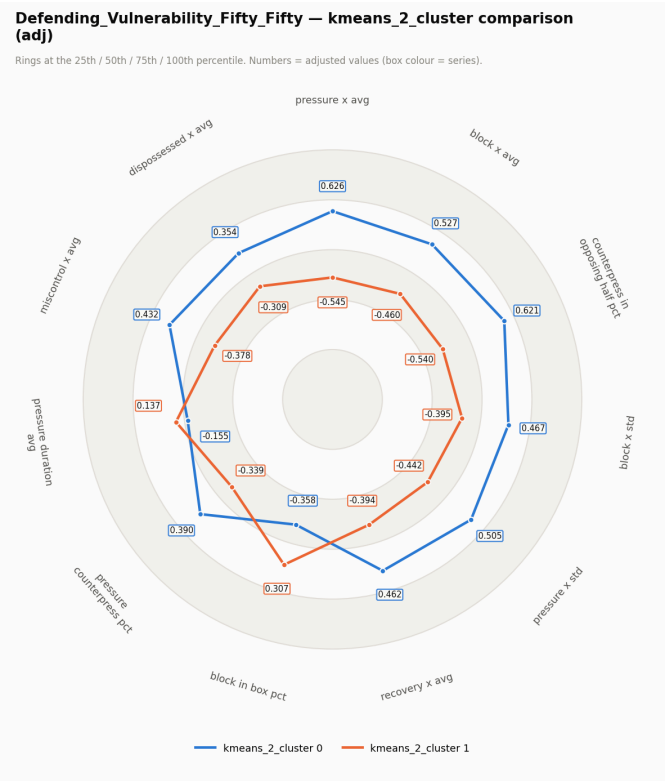


Figure 6: Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

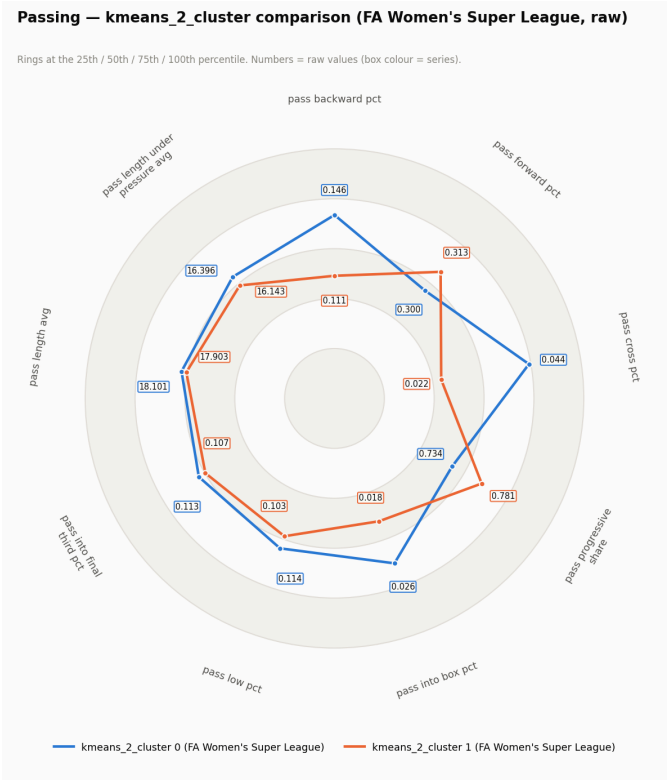


Figure 7: England Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

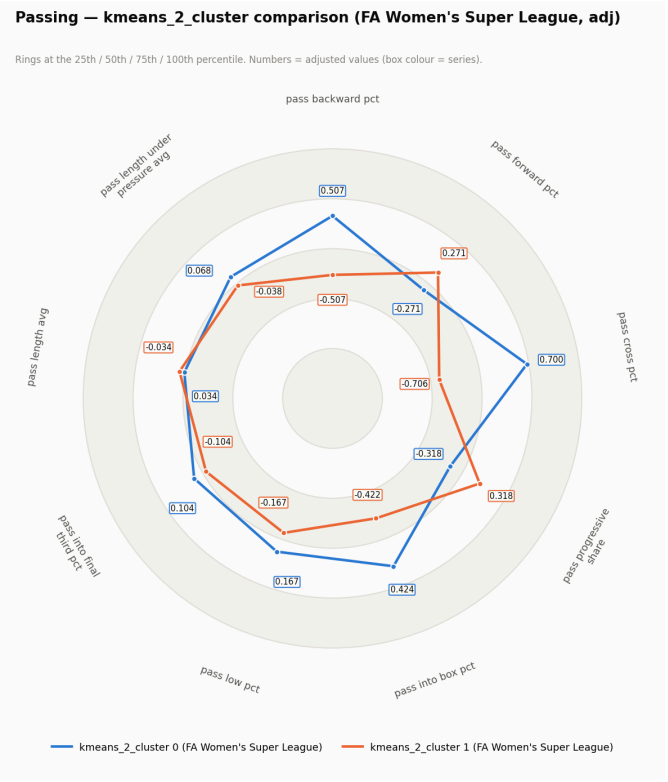


Figure 8: England Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

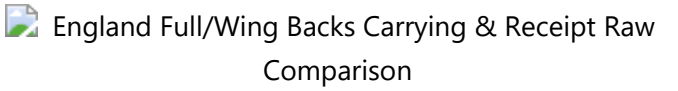


Figure 9: England Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

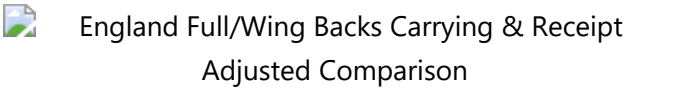


Figure 10: England Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

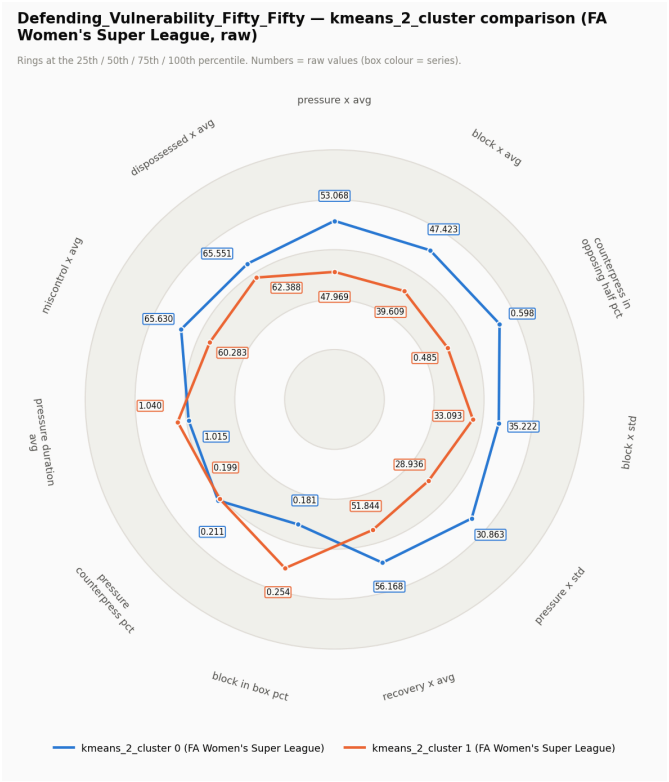


Figure 11: England Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

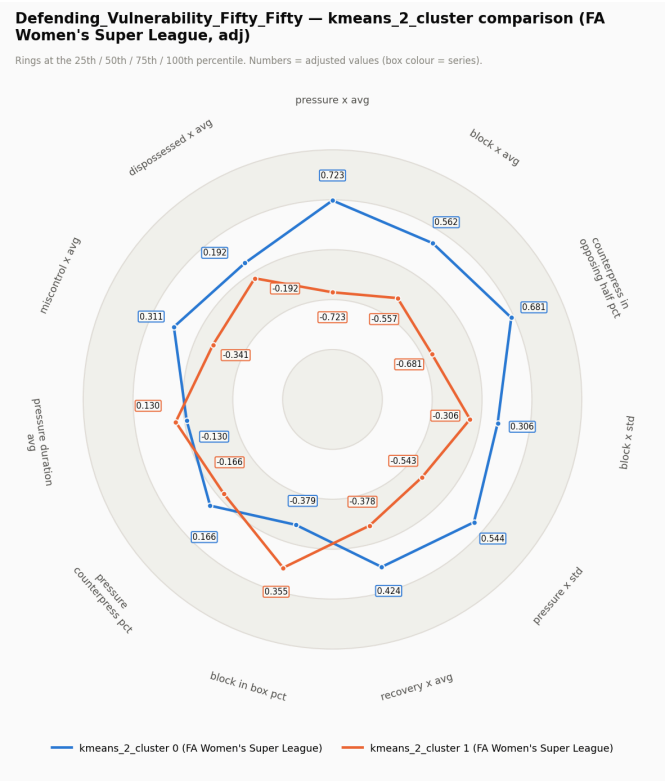


Figure 12: England Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

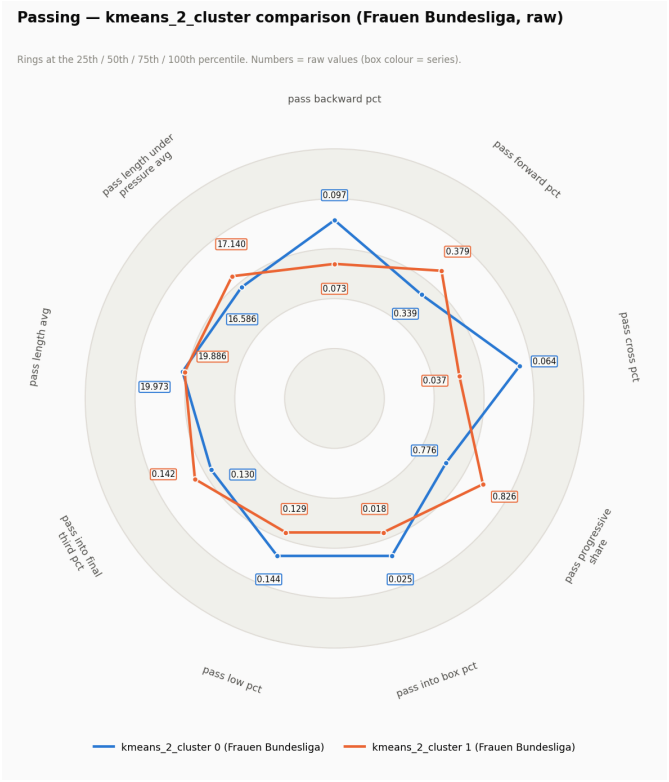


Figure 13: Germany Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

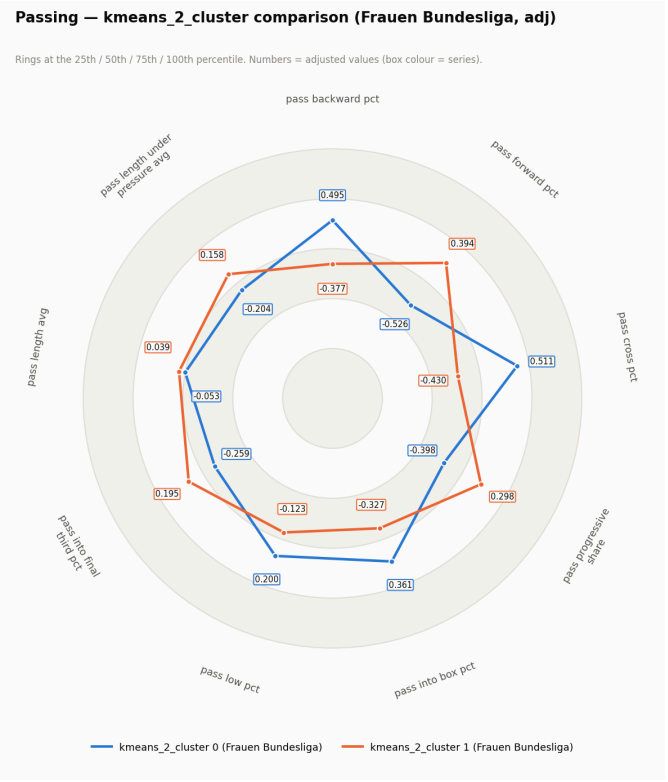


Figure 14: Germany Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

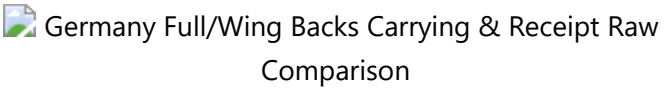


Figure 15: Germany Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

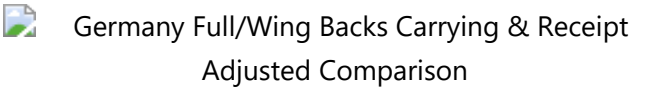


Figure 16: Germany Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

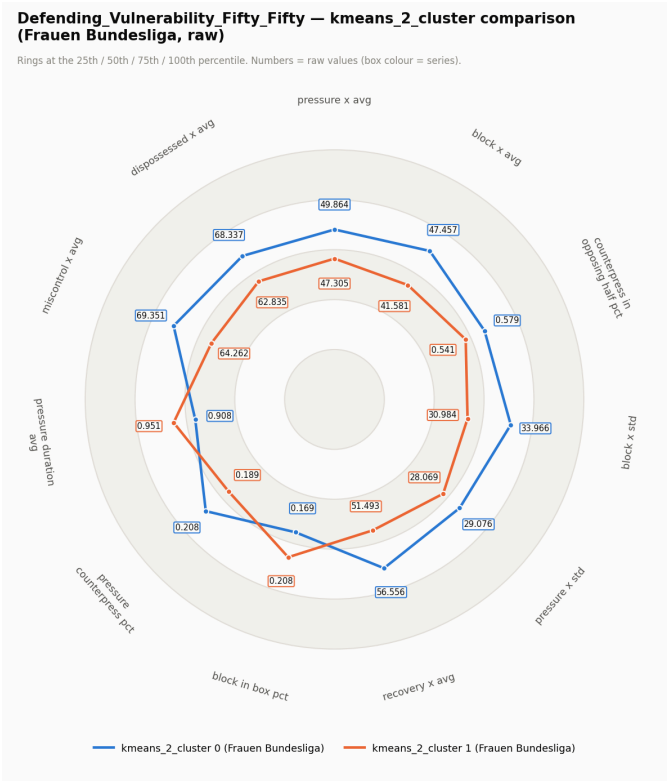


Figure 17: Germany Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

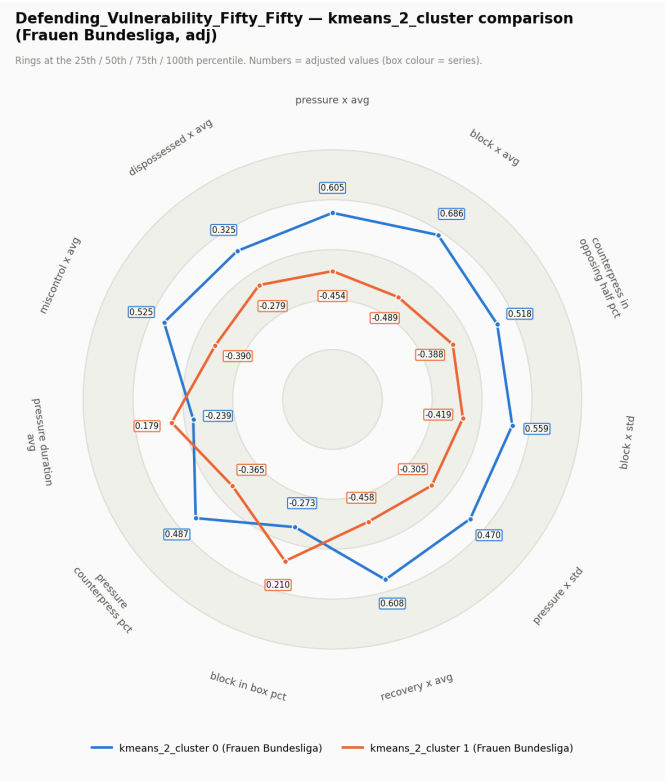


Figure 18: Germany Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

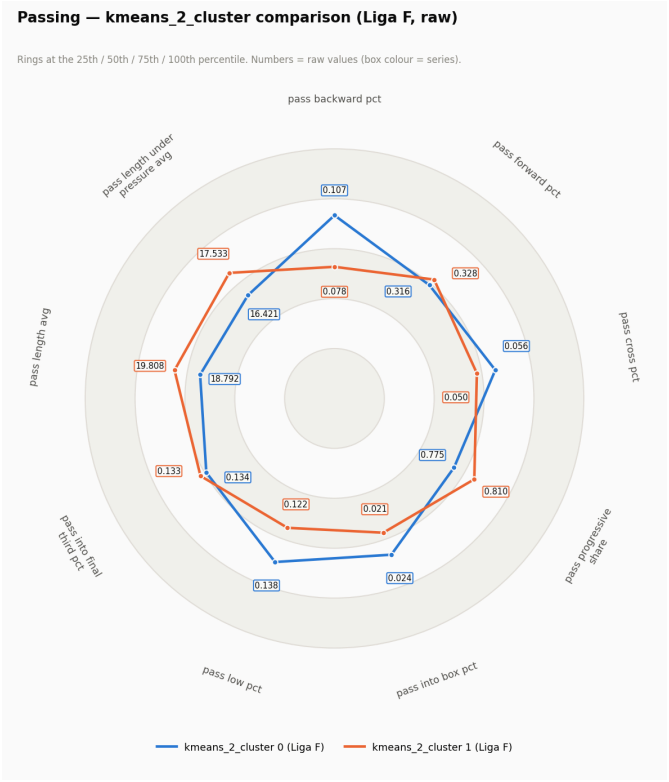


Figure 19: Spain Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

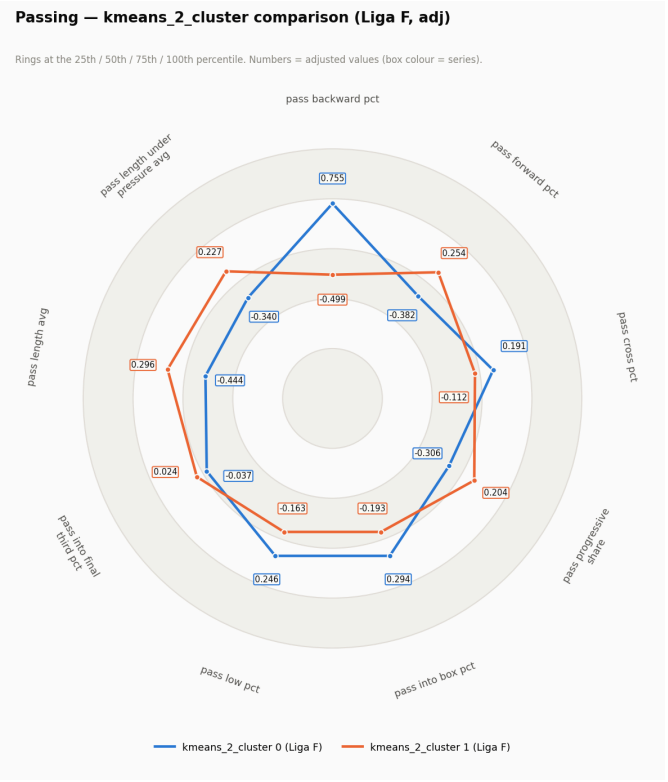


Figure 20: Spain Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt



Figure 21: Spain Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

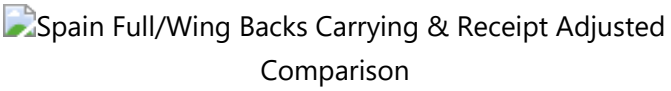


Figure 22: Spain Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

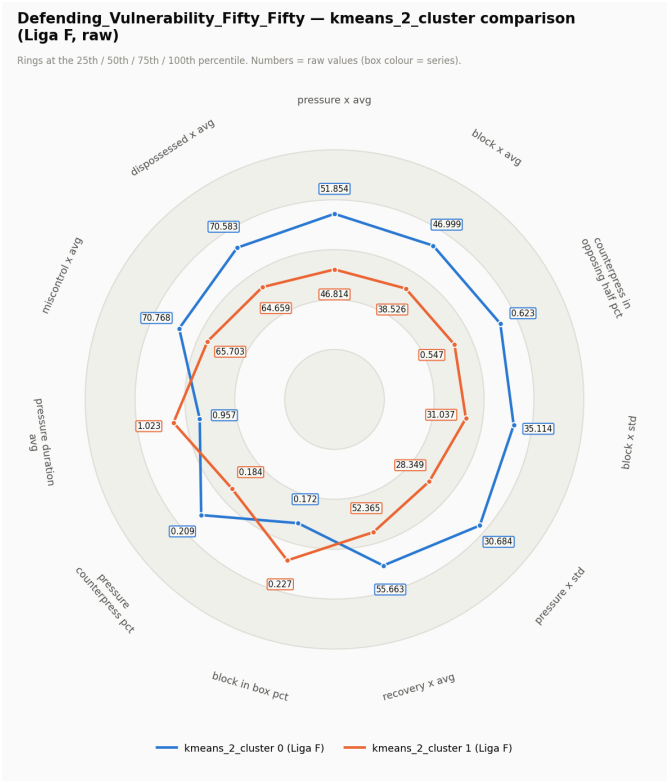


Figure 23: Spain Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

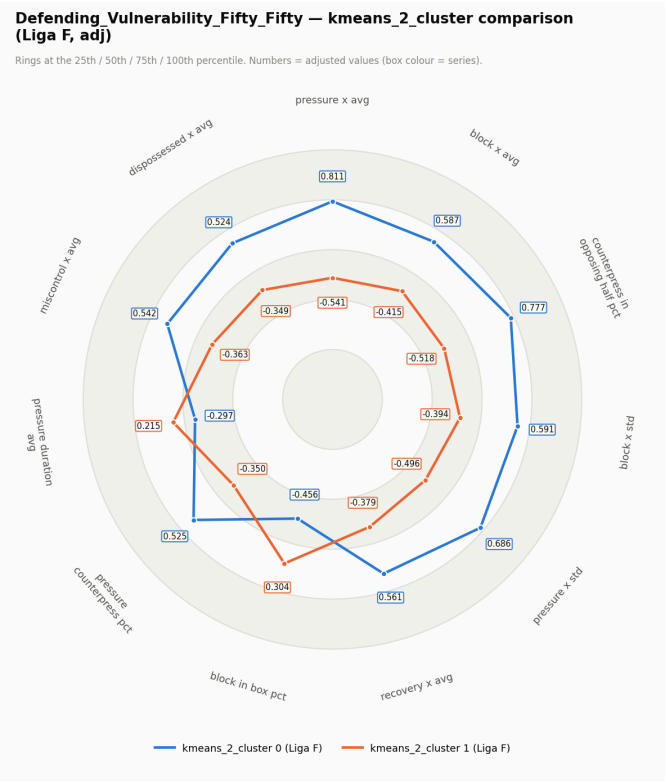


Figure 24: Spain Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

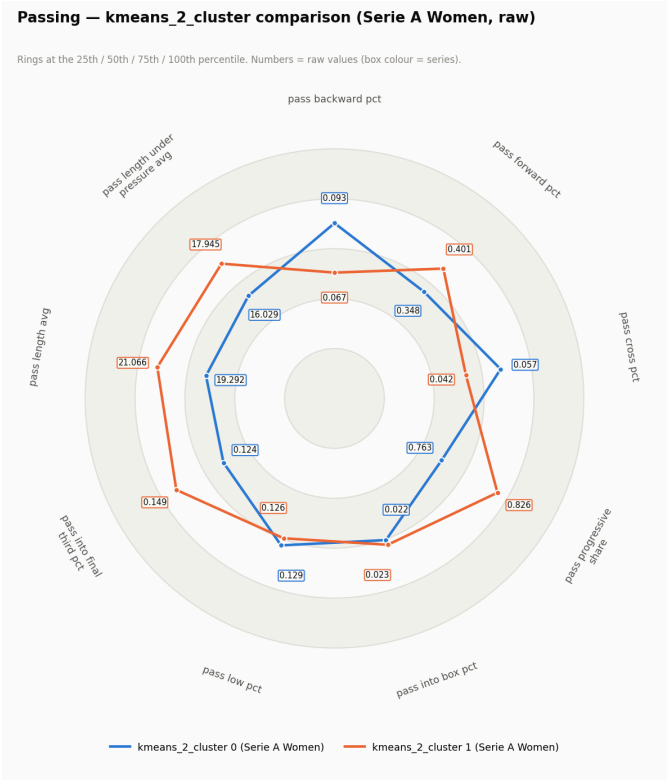


Figure 25: Italy Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

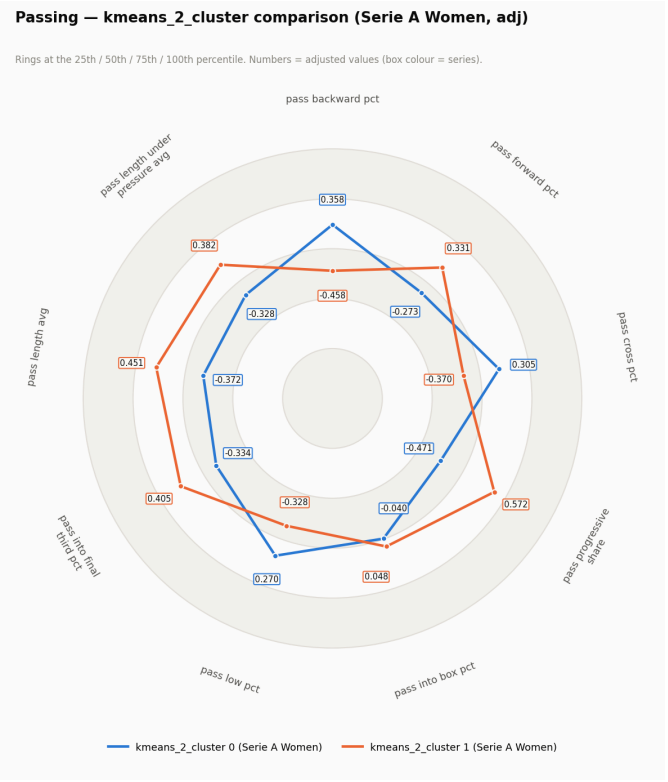


Figure 26: Italy Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

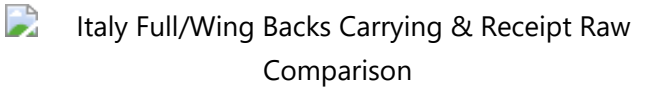


Figure 27: Italy Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

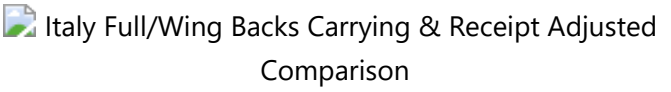


Figure 28: Italy Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

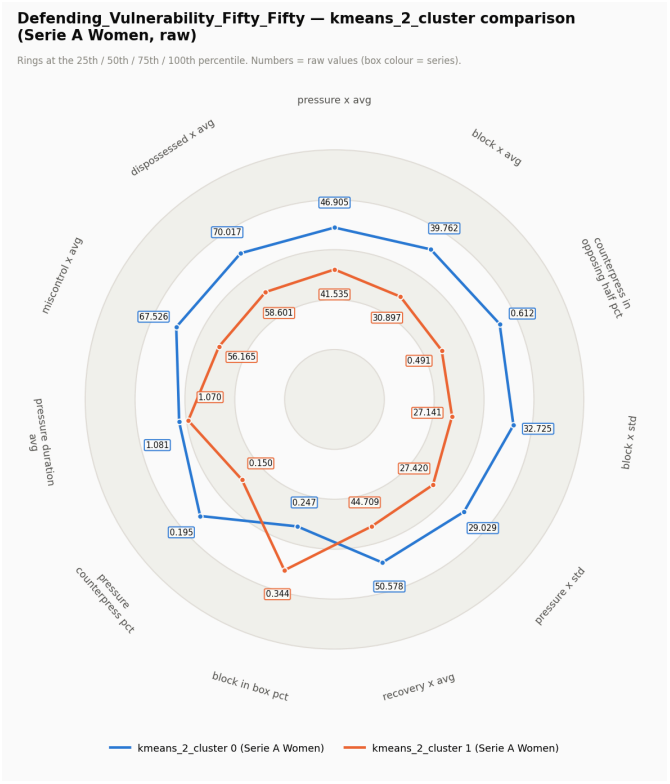


Figure 29: Italy Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

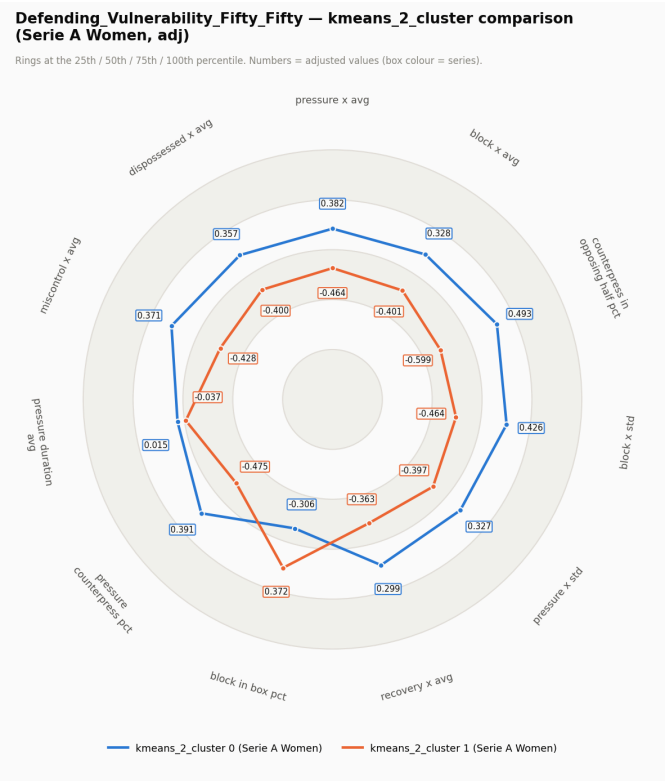


Figure 30: Italy Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Radar plots for 3 clusters full/wing backs' averages

All leagues

Passing

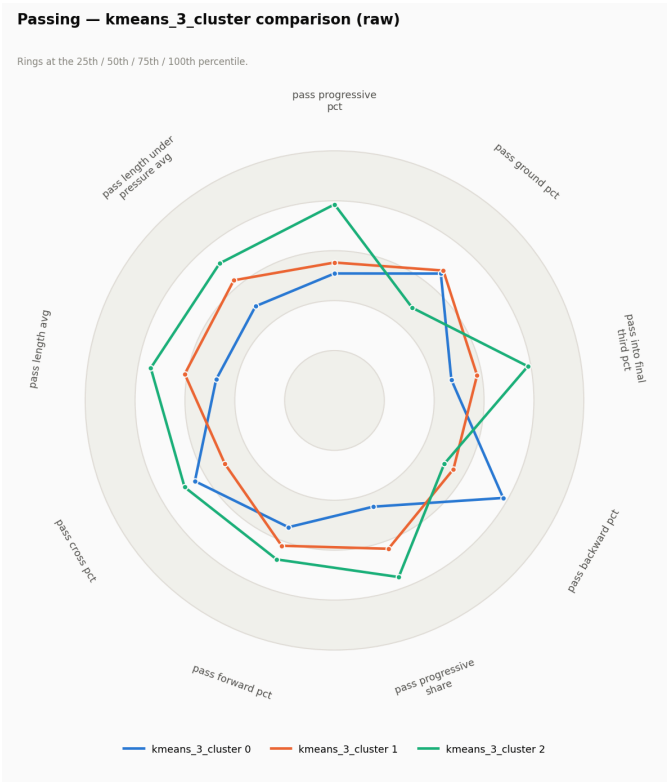


Figure 31: Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

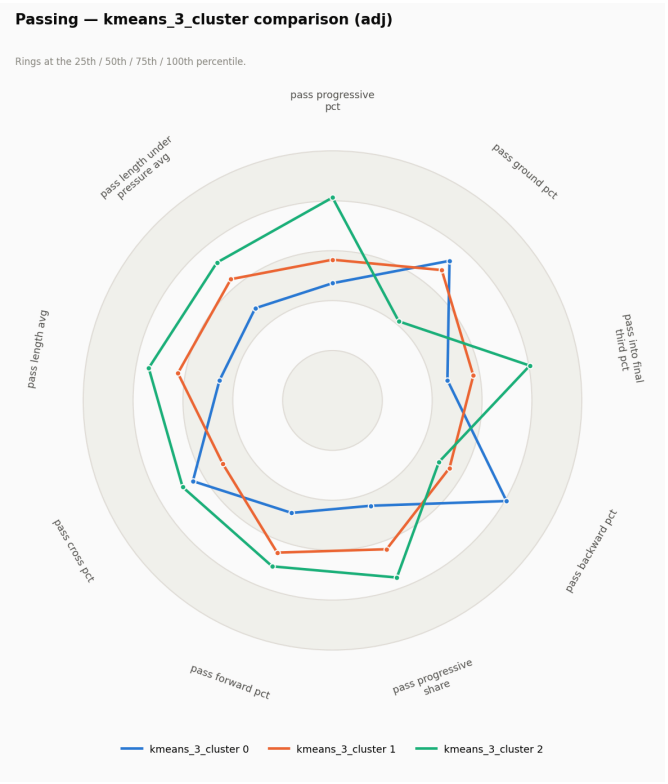


Figure 32: Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

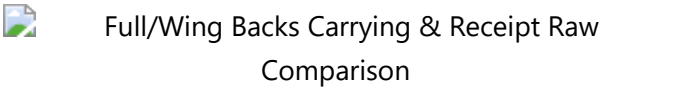


Figure 33: Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

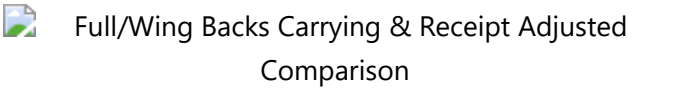


Figure 34: Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

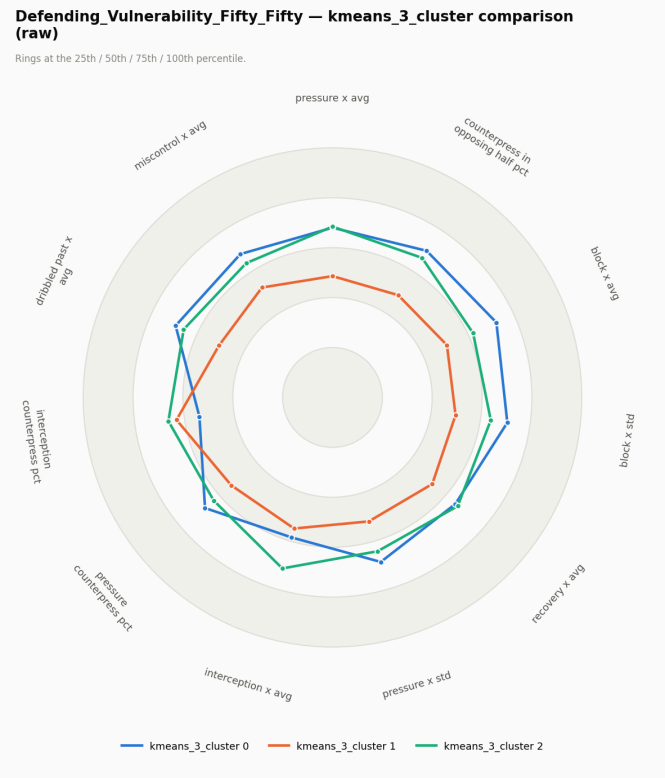


Figure 35: Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

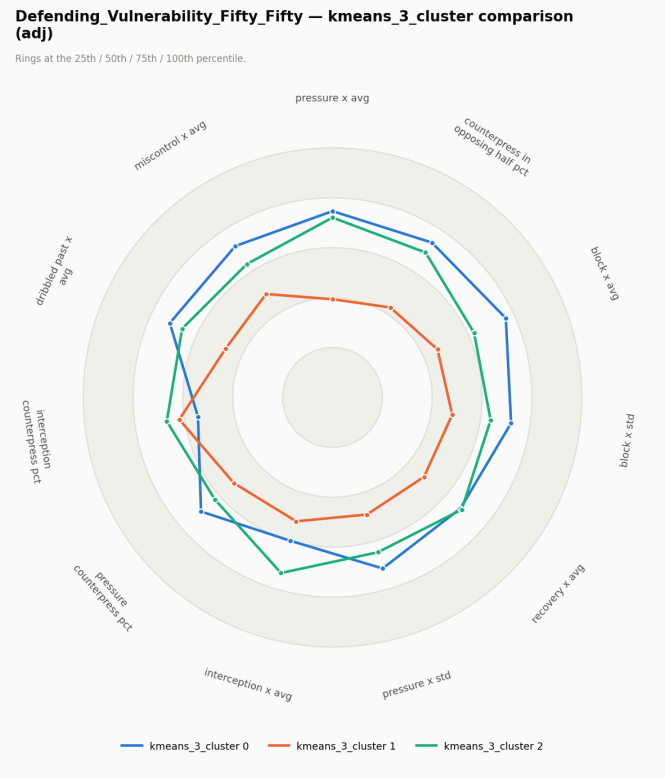


Figure 36: Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

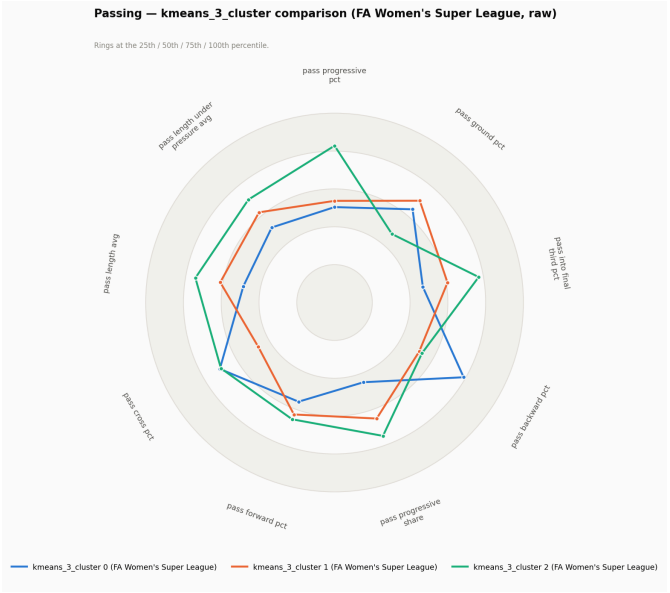


Figure 37: England Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

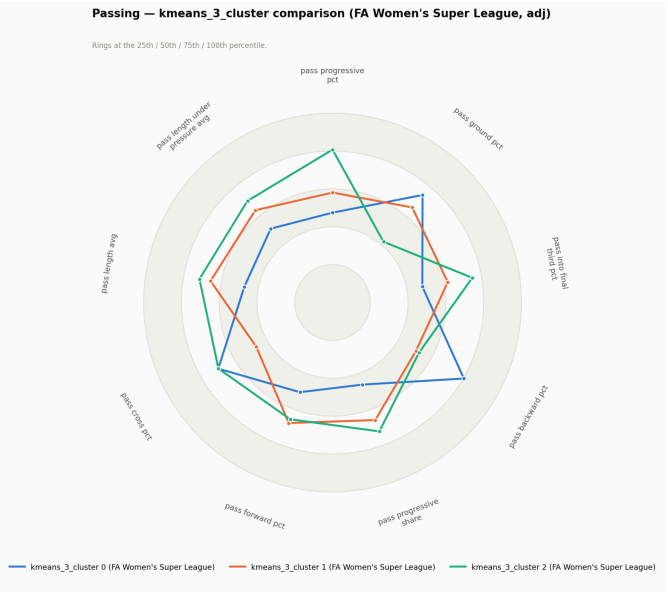


Figure 38: England Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

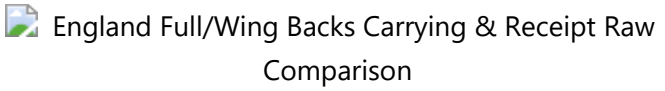


Figure 39: England Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

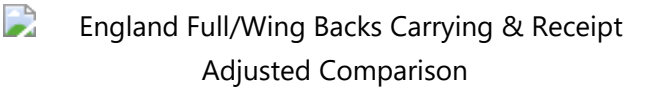


Figure 40: England Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

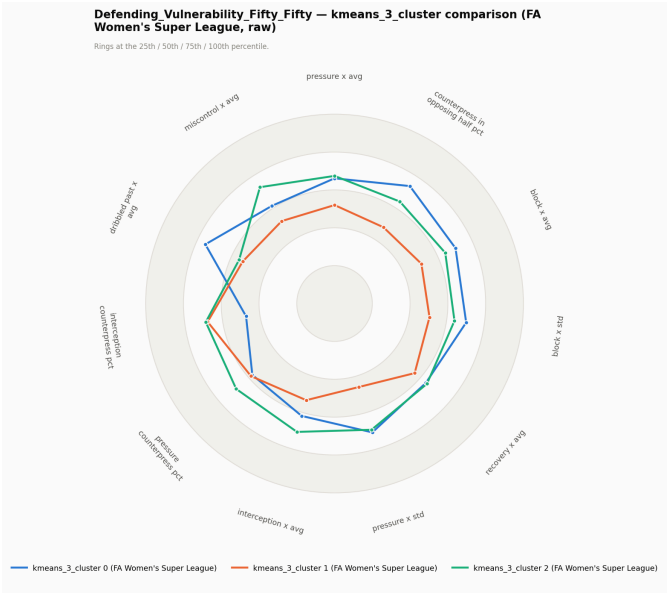


Figure 41: England Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

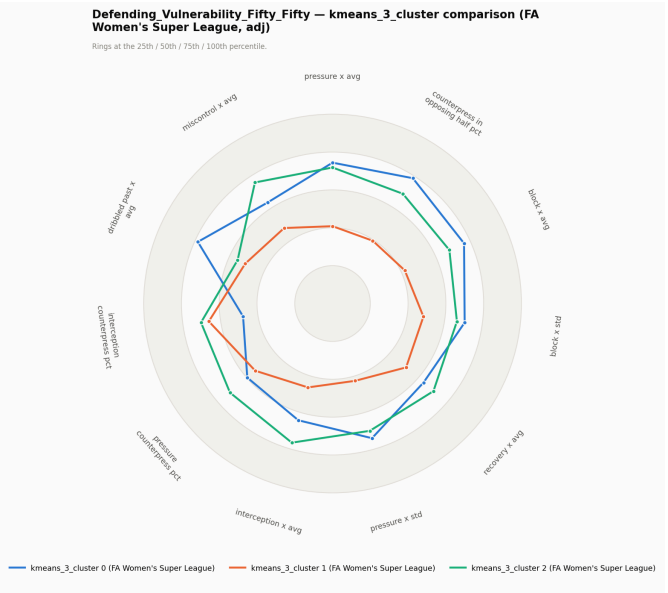


Figure 42: England Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

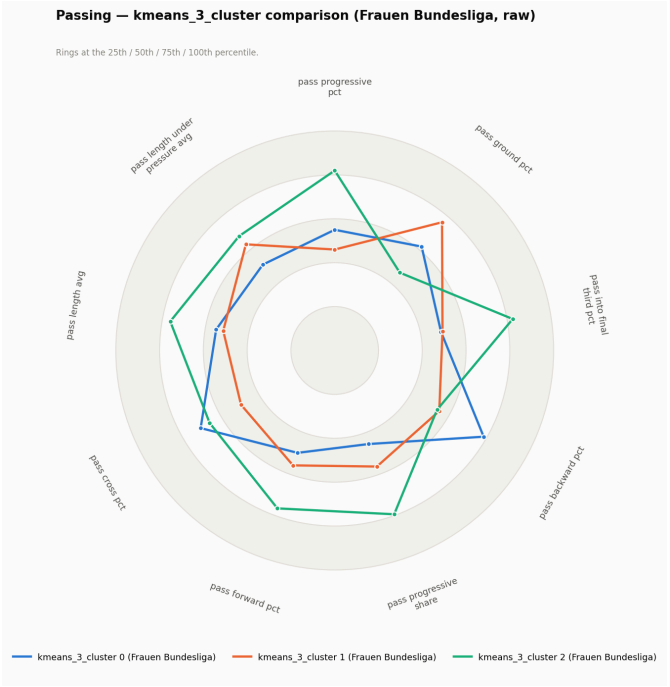


Figure 43: Germany Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

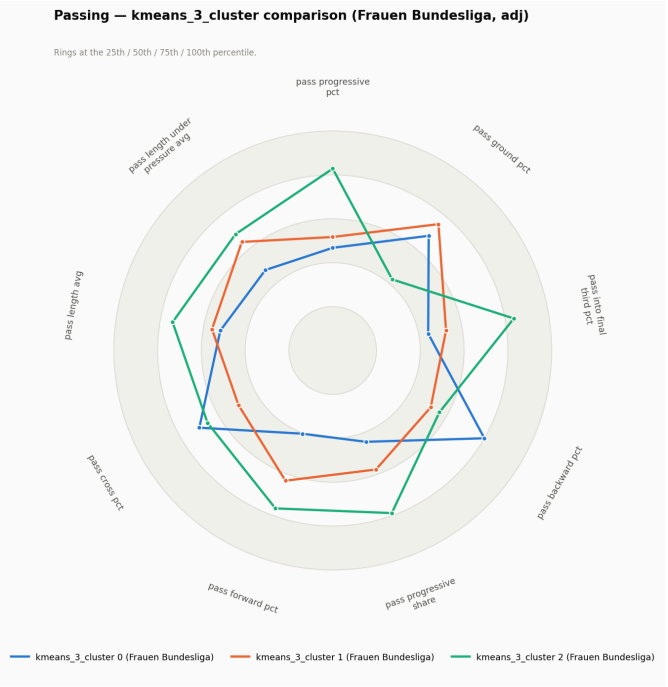


Figure 44: Germany Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

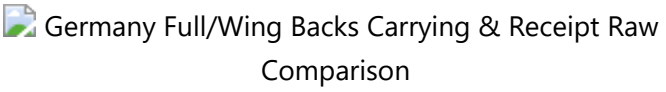


Figure 45: Germany Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

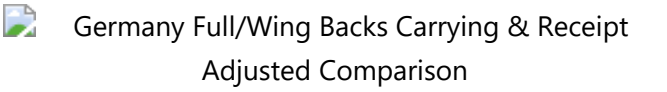


Figure 46: Germany Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

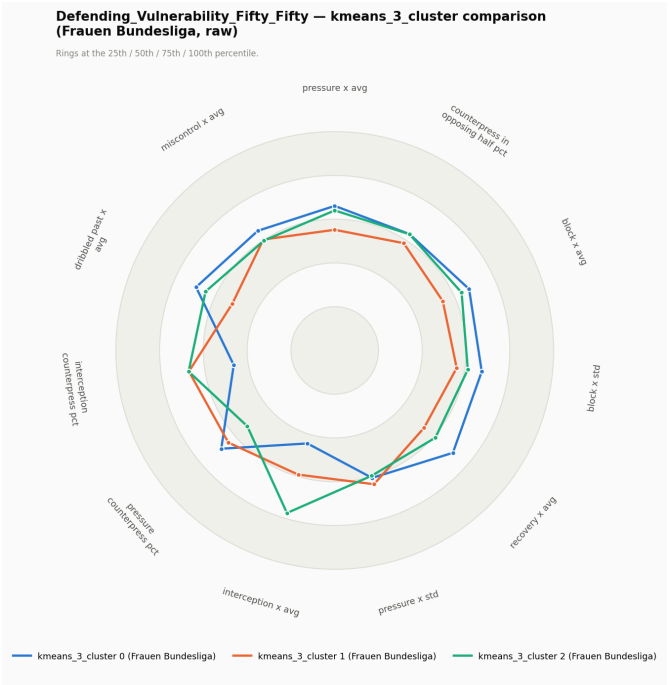


Figure 47: Germany Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

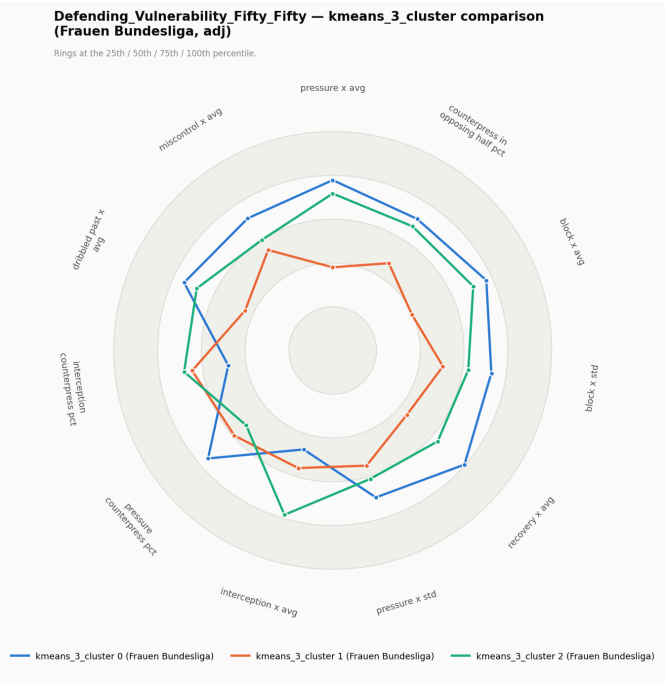


Figure 48: Germany Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

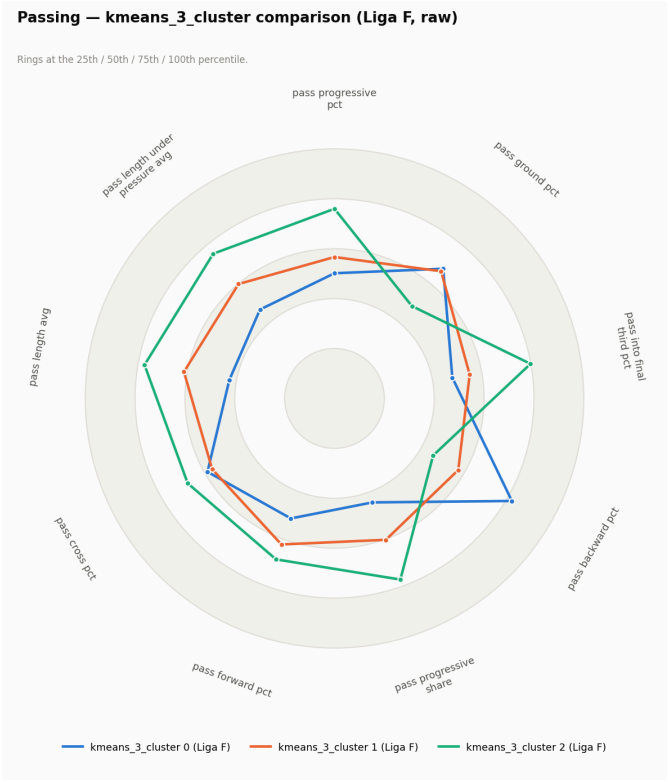


Figure 49: Spain Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

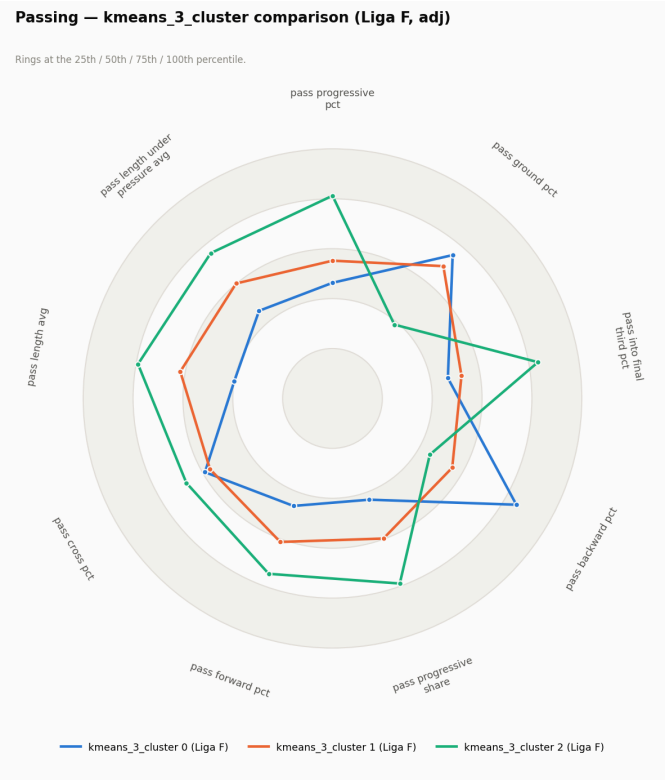


Figure 50: Spain Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt



Figure 51: Spain Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

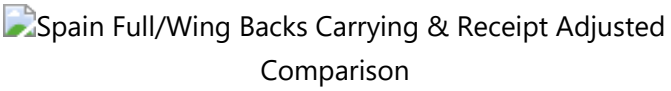


Figure 52: Spain Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

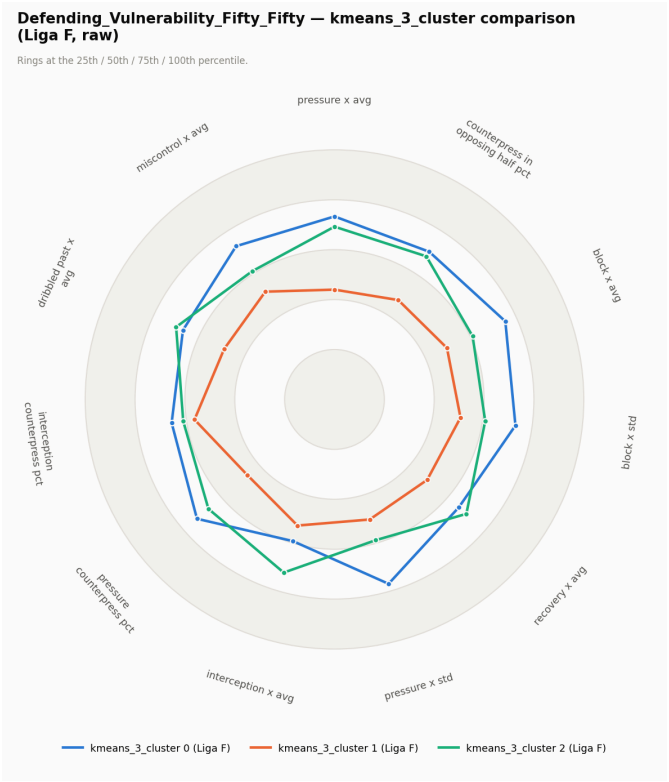


Figure 53: Spain Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

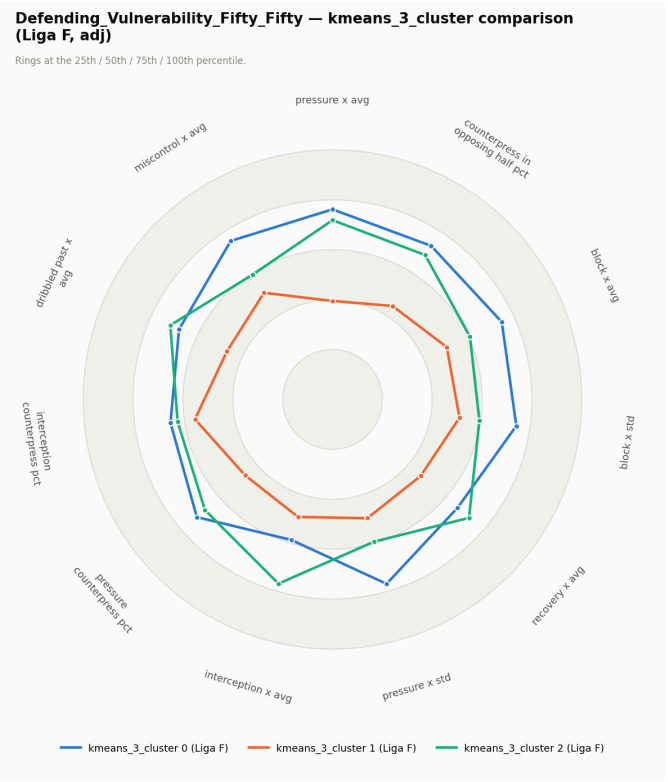


Figure 54: Spain Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

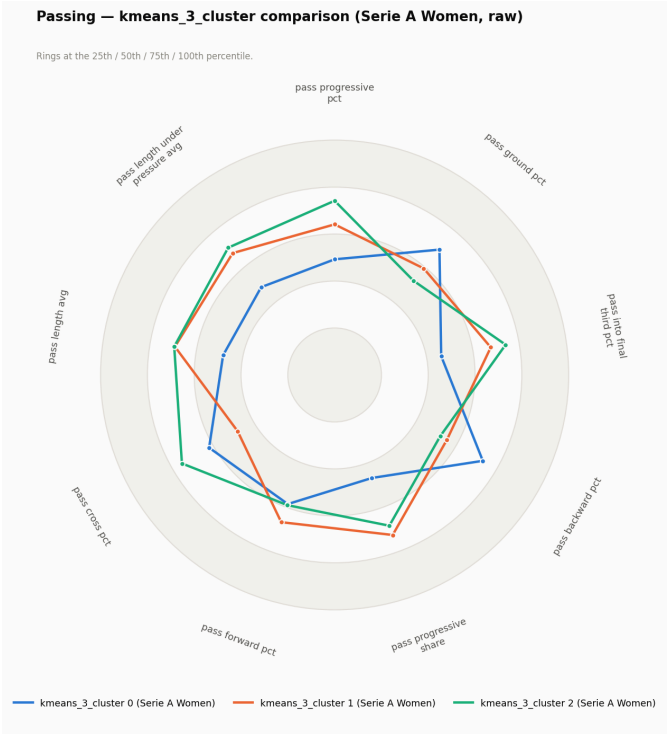


Figure 55: Italy Full/Wing Backs Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

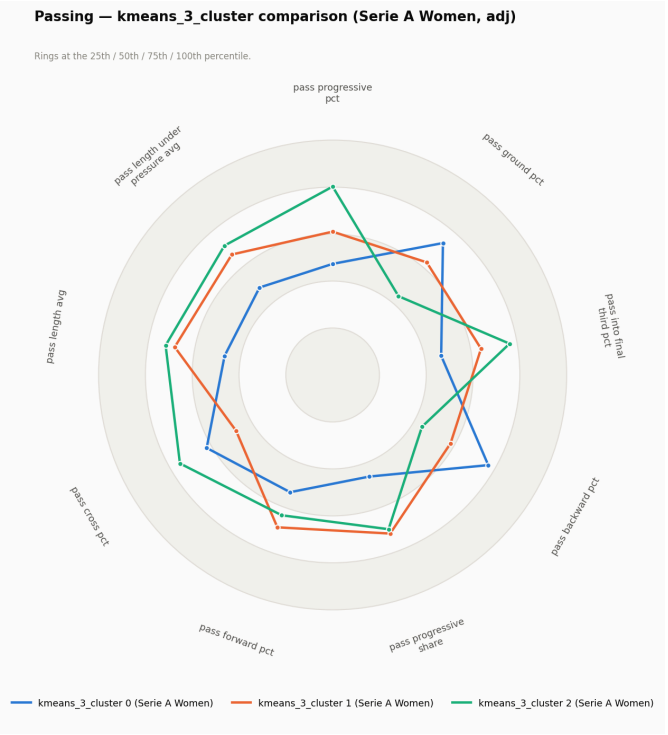


Figure 56: Italy Full/Wing Backs Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying & Receipt

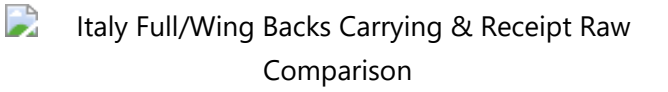


Figure 57: Italy Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

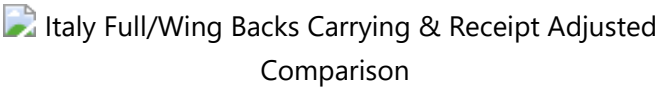


Figure 58: Italy Full/Wing Backs Carrying & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

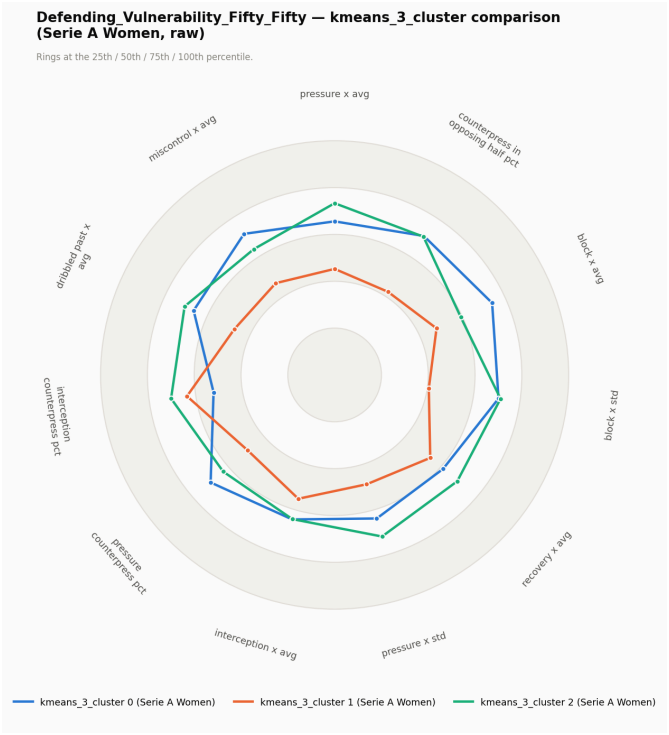


Figure 59: Italy Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

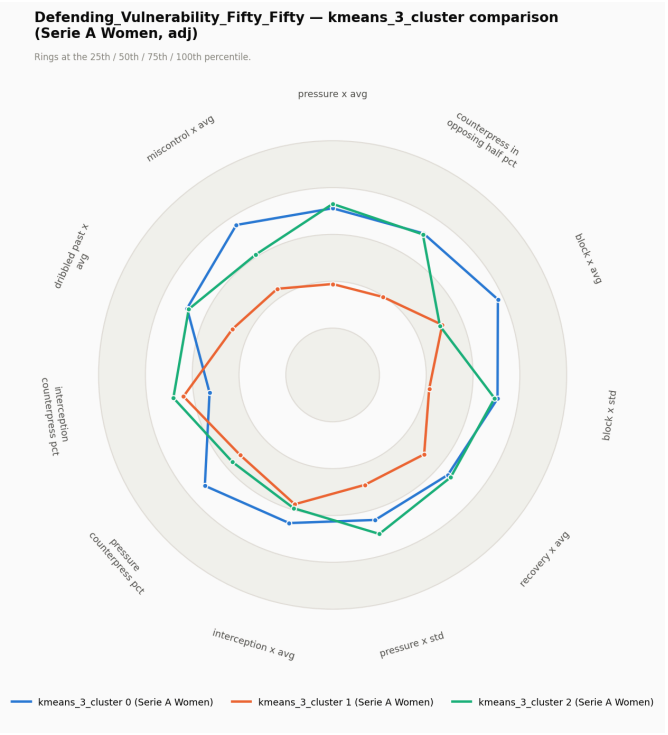


Figure 60: Italy Full/Wing Backs Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters